

TAB 19



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-334-23/24, Version: 1

Establishment of Three (3) New Magnet Centers Scheduled to Open for the 2025-2026 School Year

June 4, 2024

Student Integration Services

Action Proposed:

Approve three (3) new magnet centers to open in the 2025-2026 school year as listed below and designate them as Alternative Programs of Choice in alignment with California Education Code 58500:

Magnet Center	Grades	BD	Region
Adams MS Robotics, Automation, & Engineering	6-8	5	E
Fairfax HS Gifted	9-12	4	W
Van Deene Avenue ES Arts, Media, Music & Entertainment	K-5	7	S

Background:

Pursuant to Reference Guide 6014.7 (Procedures to Establish a New Magnet Program for the 2025-2026 School Year), schools have the opportunity to submit a proposal for the opening of a new magnet program. Student Integration Services prioritizes establishing programs that extend educational pathways, expand our menu of programs, and are located within areas of need. This year six schools submitted a formal application. In addition to the three new magnet centers being recommended, three elementary schools submitted applications, Eshleman, Valerio, and Westport Heights. These applications did not meet the rubric threshold for this year's new magnet programs.

These three new programs were chosen based on their summative rubric scores, as well as expanding our portfolio of schools. John Adams Middle School Robotics, Automation & Engineering Magnet will extend the thematic pathway, and both Fairfax High School Gifted Magnet and Van Deene Avenue Elementary Schools Arts, Media, Music & Entertainment Magnet extend a thematic pathway and address a need in the area for this specialized programming.

Schools interested in establishing a magnet program first submit a letter of intent for review and approval. The school's letter of intent is evaluated, and a feasibility study is conducted by Student Integration Services (SIS), in coordination with Master Planning and Demographics (MPD) and the Strategic Enrollment & Programs Planning Office (SEPPPO). Feedback is also solicited from the relevant Region leadership, and as applicable, Special Education, Gifted & Talented Education (GATE), Division of Instruction (DOI), the Education Transformation Office (ETO), Charter Schools Division, and Multilingual & Multicultural Education (MMED). Based on the results of the feasibility study, the school may be invited to continue the process and submit a formal magnet program proposal. Magnet proposals must address the following seven areas which are clearly delineated in the reference guide:

- Vision
- Rationale

- Equity and diversity
- Innovative curriculum and professional development
- Student achievement and instructional fidelity
- Quality instructional systems
- Family and community partnerships

The vision and rationale section of the proposal explains the need for the program, why the theme was chosen, and why the magnet program was chosen for the school. The remaining areas were developed from the Magnet Schools of America 5 pillars <https://magnet.edu/pillars>.

Before a magnet proposal is submitted, prospective schools must first complete a comprehensive process involving stakeholder input which includes, but is not limited to, a minimum of three faculty meetings and a minimum of two community meetings (including active alumni groups, faculty, staff, students, and parents). In addition, schools must submit signatures of support, a professional development timeline, and a faculty vote certification.

Once the proposals are received by SIS, a comprehensive review process occurs. Each proposal is read and scored by central office magnet coordinators. The rubric utilized to score the proposals includes each of the seven areas and their subcategories outlined in the reference guide. Special consideration is given to submissions that meet the needs and priorities of the District and SIS. Applications with the highest scores are recommended for opening.

Expected Outcomes:

In 1976, the California Supreme Court ordered the District to “...undertake reasonably feasible steps to alleviate school desegregation, regardless of cause.” To meet this constitutional obligation, the District submitted a desegregation plan to the Los Angeles County Superior Court in June 1981, which was approved by a Court Order in September 1981, subject to several specific modifications. The 1981 Order has never been reversed, vacated, or overruled, and the District is obligated to fulfill its terms by continuing to implement the Desegregation Plan.

The Desegregation plan’s goals are threefold:

1. First, it seeks to provide the maximum number of minority children with the opportunity to attend desegregated schools.
2. Second, it seeks to preserve the integrated nature of schools and neighborhoods that have achieved that result through residential integration and through voluntary desegregation programs.
3. Third, it seeks to alleviate the harmful effects of racial isolation for those students who attend schools which will remain racially isolated because of the District’s predominantly minority enrollment.

To achieve these goals, the plan utilizes several components, one of which is the “Magnet Component.”

The creation of these magnet centers would:

- Increase access to quality choice schools.
- Increase the number of seats available in the magnet program.
- Increase diversity in racially isolated schools by offering innovative programs in specialized settings,

thus attracting students from throughout the District.

- Prepare students both for direct entry into California’s vibrant industry sectors and for postsecondary education.

Board Options and Consequences:

A “Yes” vote, will increase the number of magnet seats for students to participate in the court-ordered voluntary integration program and allow flexibilities afforded in California Education Code 58500 (i.e. credential flexibility).

A “No” vote, will result in not opening the proposed magnet programs.

Policy Implications:

This proposal is also in response to the Board Resolution, Enrollment and Equal Access through LAUSD Choice that was passed on January 10, 2012, which stated “the Los Angeles Unified School District has struggled with declining enrollment for the last five years.”

Budget Impact:

Per the District’s Magnet Schools and Centers Staffing Ratios for FY 2024-25, the new Magnet programs will be normed accordingly. Based on the proposed capacity, the Van Deene Avenue Elementary School magnet program would be eligible for a 0.5 FTE coordinator positions. All programs will be designated as Predominately Hispanic, Black, Asian, and other Non-Anglo (PHBAO). Based on projected enrollment, the Adams Middle School magnet program would generate one additional teacher position. Additional discretionary resources at \$17 per student to purchase instructional materials to implement the magnet themes totaling \$7,650.00 for all programs. Based on the proposed capacity for each magnet program, there would be the following costs of additional staffing and resources for these magnet programs.

Budget Summary

Coordinators (1)	\$	95,799.00
Teachers (1)	\$	140,889.00
Resources @\$17 per student	\$	<u>7,650.00</u>
Approximate Total Cost	\$	244,338.00

Student Impact:

The opening of these new centers would provide families with other choices for their children’s education. Students will have access to experience-based learning environments including Robotics, automation, engineering; Arts, media, music, and entertainment; and Gifted. Students will also actively develop connections with experts and professionals throughout the community, both locally and globally.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	Magnet Programs were created to address, correct, and alleviate the harms of racial isolation. They were also created to provide a more rigorous option for families zoned to underperforming schools.

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Resource Prioritization	3	These new programs with varied magnet themes will expand the District's magnet portfolio to serve more diverse students.
Results	3	These programs with rigorous educational options will position students for a greater potential for success in elementary, middle, and high school and beyond.
TOTAL	10	

Issues and Analysis:

Not Applicable

Attachments:

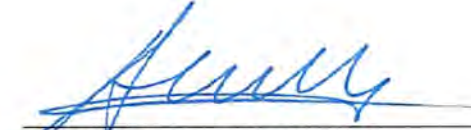
Attachment A - Desegregation Impact Statements (3)

Informatives:

Not Applicable

Submitted:

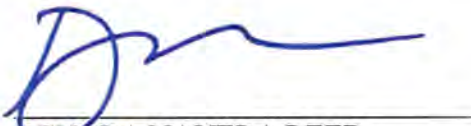
05/07/24

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

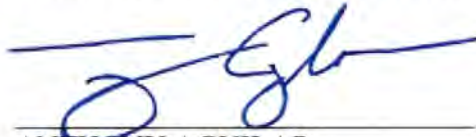
APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


DR. KARLA V. ESTRADA
Chief of Special Education, Equity and
Deputy Superintendent of Instruction

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

✓ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


ANTHONY AGUILAR
Chief of Special Education, Equity and
Specialized Programs
Office of the Chief of Special Education,
Equity and Specialized Programs

REVIEWED BY:


NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

✓ Approved as to budget impact statement.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


DR. KEITH H. ABRAHAMS III
Executive Director
Student Integration Services

**LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
Board of Education Report**

**DESEGREGATION IMPACT STATEMENT (DIS)
Adams Middle School Robotics, Automation & Engineering Magnet**

I. Category of Proposed Action:

The proposed action would create a magnet center, Adams Middle School Robotics, Automation & Engineering Magnet and provide 35 magnet seats in grade 6 for the 2025-2026 school year. The program will grow to 70 seats in grades 6-7 for the 2026-2027 school year and finally grow to 104 seats in grades 6-8 for the 2027-2028 school year.

II. Summary Description of Current District Practice:

Magnet schools and centers are Court-Ordered voluntary integration programs that are open to all students who live within the boundaries of the Los Angeles Unified School District. Magnet Programs were established by Court order to address the five (5) Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self-Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions. All participating students take the required coursework necessary for promotion and graduation and have the opportunity to meet all requirements for entrance to the University of California and the California State Universities.

III. Proposed Change:

The opening of the Adams MS Magnet will create additional magnet seats for students who have an academic interest in the robotics, automation and engineering course of study.

IV. Effects of This Proposal:

The establishment of the magnet program would give the District the ability to open a magnet center in Region East that would provide additional magnet seats. It would also offer greater choice for students and reduce the time and distance required to travel to a quality school of choice.

V. Analyze the Impact of This Proposal on Integration, Desegregation, Resegregation, and/or Segregation

If the Crawford Court Order goals are met, there should be positive results on the five Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions.

VI. If proposed action affects negatively any desegregation program, list other option(s) identified:

If the Crawford Court-Order and District policies and practices are followed, there will not be a negative effect on the District's Desegregation Plan.

PREPARED BY:



FELIPE ECHAVARRI
Coordinator
Student Integration Services

APPROVED BY:



KEITH H. ABRAHAMS III
Executive Director
Student Integration Services

**LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
Board of Education Report**

**DESEGREGATION IMPACT STATEMENT (DIS)
Fairfax High School Gifted Magnet**

I. Category of Proposed Action:

The proposed action would create a magnet center, Fairfax High School Gifted Magnet and provide 104 magnet seats in grades 9-10 for the 2025-2026 school year. The program will grow to 104 seats in grades 9-11 for the 2026-2027 school year and finally grow to 208 seats in grades 9-12 for the 2027-2028 school year.

II. Summary Description of Current District Practice:

Magnet schools and centers are Court-Ordered voluntary integration programs that are open to all students who live within the boundaries of the Los Angeles Unified School District. Magnet Programs were established by Court order to address the five (5) Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self-Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions. All participating students take the required coursework necessary for promotion and graduation and have the opportunity to meet all requirements for entrance to the University of California and the California State Universities.

III. Proposed Change:

The opening of the Fairfax HS Magnet will create additional magnet seats for students who have an academic interest in the gifted course of study.

IV. Effects of This Proposal:

The establishment of the magnet program would give the District the ability to open a magnet center in Region West that would provide additional magnet seats. It would also offer greater choice for students and reduce the time and distance required to travel to a quality school of choice.

V. Analyze the Impact of This Proposal on Integration, Desegregation, Resegregation, and/or Segregation

If the Crawford Court Order goals are met, there should be positive results on the five Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions.

VI. If proposed action affects negatively any desegregation program, list other option(s) identified:

If the Crawford Court-Order and District policies and practices are followed, there will not be a negative effect on the District's Desegregation Plan.

PREPARED BY:



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**LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
Board of Education Report**

DESEGREGATION IMPACT STATEMENT (DIS)

Van Deene Avenue Elementary School Arts, Media, Music & Entertainment Magnet

I. Category of Proposed Action:

The proposed action would create a magnet center, Van Deene Avenue Elementary School Arts, Media, Music & Entertainment Magnet and provide 138 magnet seats in grades K-5 for the 2025-2026 school year.

II. Summary Description of Current District Practice:

Magnet schools and centers are Court-Ordered voluntary integration programs that are open to all students who live within the boundaries of the Los Angeles Unified School District. Magnet Programs were established by Court order to address the five (5) Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self-Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions. All participating students take the required coursework necessary for promotion and graduation and have the opportunity to meet all requirements for entrance to the University of California and the California State Universities.

III. Proposed Change:

The opening of the Van Deene Av ES Magnet will create additional magnet seats for students who have an academic interest in the arts, media, music, and entertainment course of study.

IV. Effects of This Proposal:

The establishment of the magnet program would give the District the ability to open a magnet center in Region South that would provide additional magnet seats. It would also offer greater choice for students and reduce the time and distance required to travel to a quality school of choice.

V. Analyze the Impact of This Proposal on Integration, Desegregation, Resegregation, and/or Segregation

If the Crawford Court Order goals are met, there should be positive results on the five Harms of Racial Isolation: Low Academic Achievement; Low Self Esteem; Lack of Access to Postsecondary Opportunities; Interracial Hostility and Intolerance; and Overcrowded Conditions.

VI. If proposed action affects negatively any desegregation program, list other option(s) identified:

If the Crawford Court-Order and District policies and practices are followed, there will not be a negative effect on the District's Desegregation Plan.

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